

Final Report

Stakeholder-facing summary of the refreshed PSID crisis-module package

52 Ranked questions	28 Selected questions	29.98 Selected minutes	2.201 Average Ri
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Executive summary

- The final client-facing category model is now Generic versus Specific.
- The previous Financial Crisis label has been removed as a final category and retained only as a traceability field.
- The final selected module contains 28 questions and stays under the 30-minute administration cap.
- The package now separates technical explanation, deployable wording, and stakeholder reporting into distinct deliverables.

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Background and Objective

Why the package was refreshed and what changed

Project goal

The PSID archive contains crisis-related items from multiple historical contexts. The client requirement was to turn that archive into a simpler and more defensible package: a cleaner deployable questionnaire, a technical codebook, and a stakeholder-facing report that explains the shortlist without overemphasizing finance-only content.

What changed

- Binary Generic/Specific category model replaces the older multi-label final structure.
- Financial Crisis is no longer treated as a separate final module category.
- The 0.7 client threshold is implemented on normalized Ri rather than raw Ri.
- The final CSV is rebuilt from the raw integrated source during every refresh.

Methodology

How the ranking and categorization logic works in plain language

Pipeline overview

- Load 52 historical questions from the integrated source file.
- Reuse stored keyword lists and map them to constructs such as Employment, Government Aid, and Trauma / Health.
- Calculate utility, burden, and the baseline Ri ranking score.
- Normalize Ri and apply the 0.7 threshold to assign Generic or Specific.
- Compute the enhanced Pi score using rarity, construct coverage, portability, and redundancy penalties.
- Select the final module greedily under the 30-minute cap.

Key formulas

Field	Formula
Ri	U_i / B_i
Bi	$\max(0.10 * \text{word_count} + 0.20 * \text{complexity}, 0.1)$
minutes	$(\text{word_count} * 7) / 60$
ri_threshold_score	$(R_i - \min(R_i)) / (\max(R_i) - \min(R_i))$
Pi	$\text{augmented_utility} / [B_i * (1 + 0.65 * \text{redundancy_scaled})]$

Results

Updated counts, source mix, and top questions

Headline metrics

Metric	Value	Source	Selected
Selected questions	28	Hurricane Katrina 2007	14
Selected minutes	29.98	COVID-19	8
Average Ri	2.201	Govt Shutdown Income	3
Average Pi	2.561	Understanding Society	2
Generic rows	3	Govt Shutdown Crisis	1
Specific rows	49		

Top Generic and Specific examples

Generic

Variable	Question	Ri
GEN_LOSE_EARNINGS_PANDEMIC	Did you lose earnings because of the pandemic?	5.667
GEN_EXPERIENCED_FINANCIAL_DIFFICULTIES	Have you experienced any financial difficulties because of the crisis?	5.667
GEN_RECEIVE_STIMULUS_PAYMENT_OR_OTHER_EMERGENCY_SUPPORT	Did you receive a stimulus payment or other emergency government support?	4.667

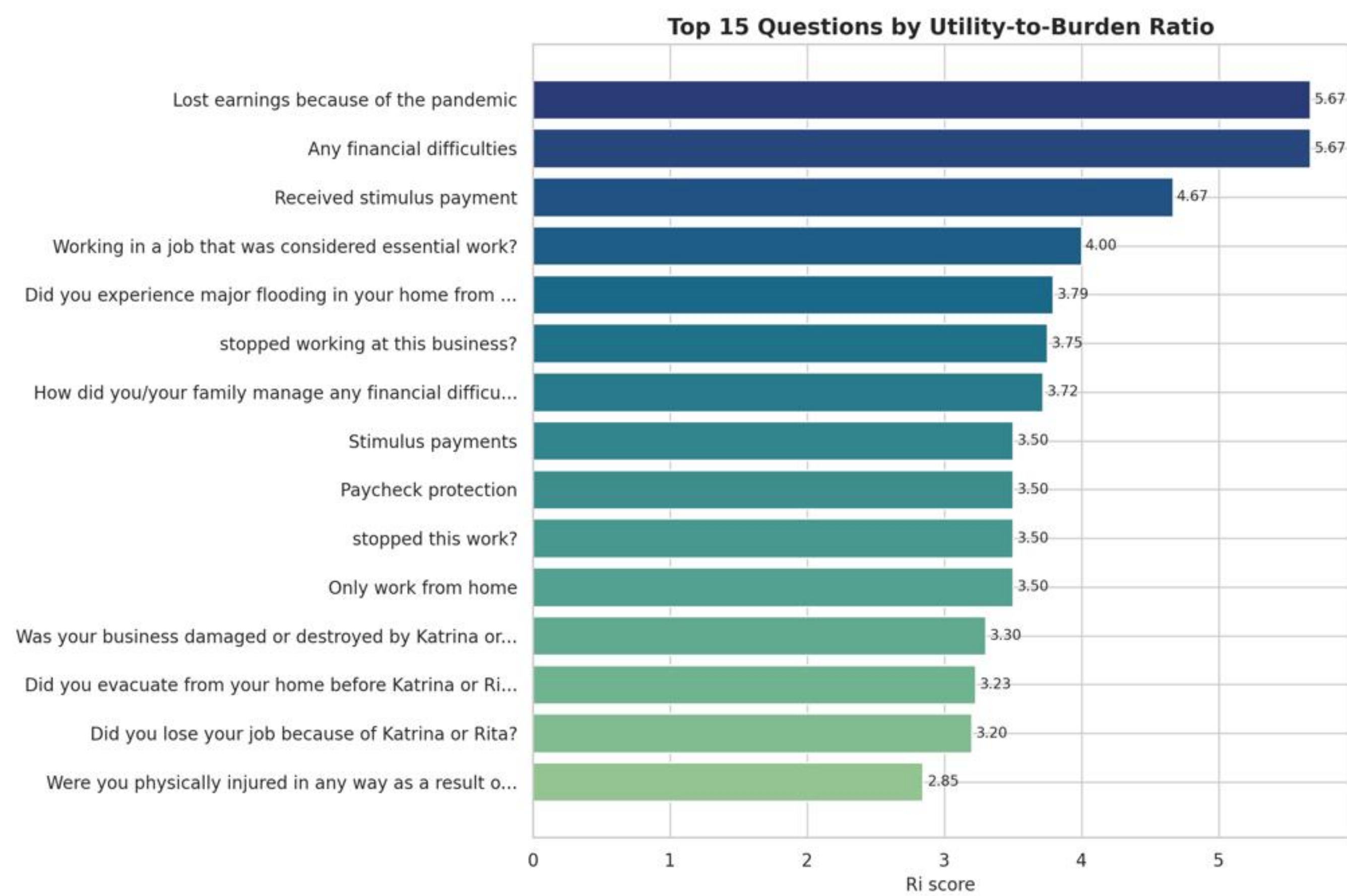
Specific

Variable	Question	Ri
SPC_WORKING_JOB_CONSIDERED_ESSENTIAL	Were you working in a job that was considered essential during the crisis?	4.000
SPC_EXPERIENCE_MAJOR_FLOODING_DURING_DISASTER	Did you experience major flooding in your home during the disaster?	3.792
SPC_STOPPED_WORKING_BUSINESS_OR_SELF_EMPLOYED	Have you stopped working at this business because of the crisis?	3.750
SPC_HOUSEHOLD_MANAGE_FINANCIAL_DIFFICULTIES	How did your household manage financial difficulties caused by the shutdown or crisis?	3.719
SPC_RECEIVE_PAYCHECK_PROTECTION_OR_OTHER_EMERGENCY_SUPPORT	Did you receive paycheck protection or other emergency business support?	3.500

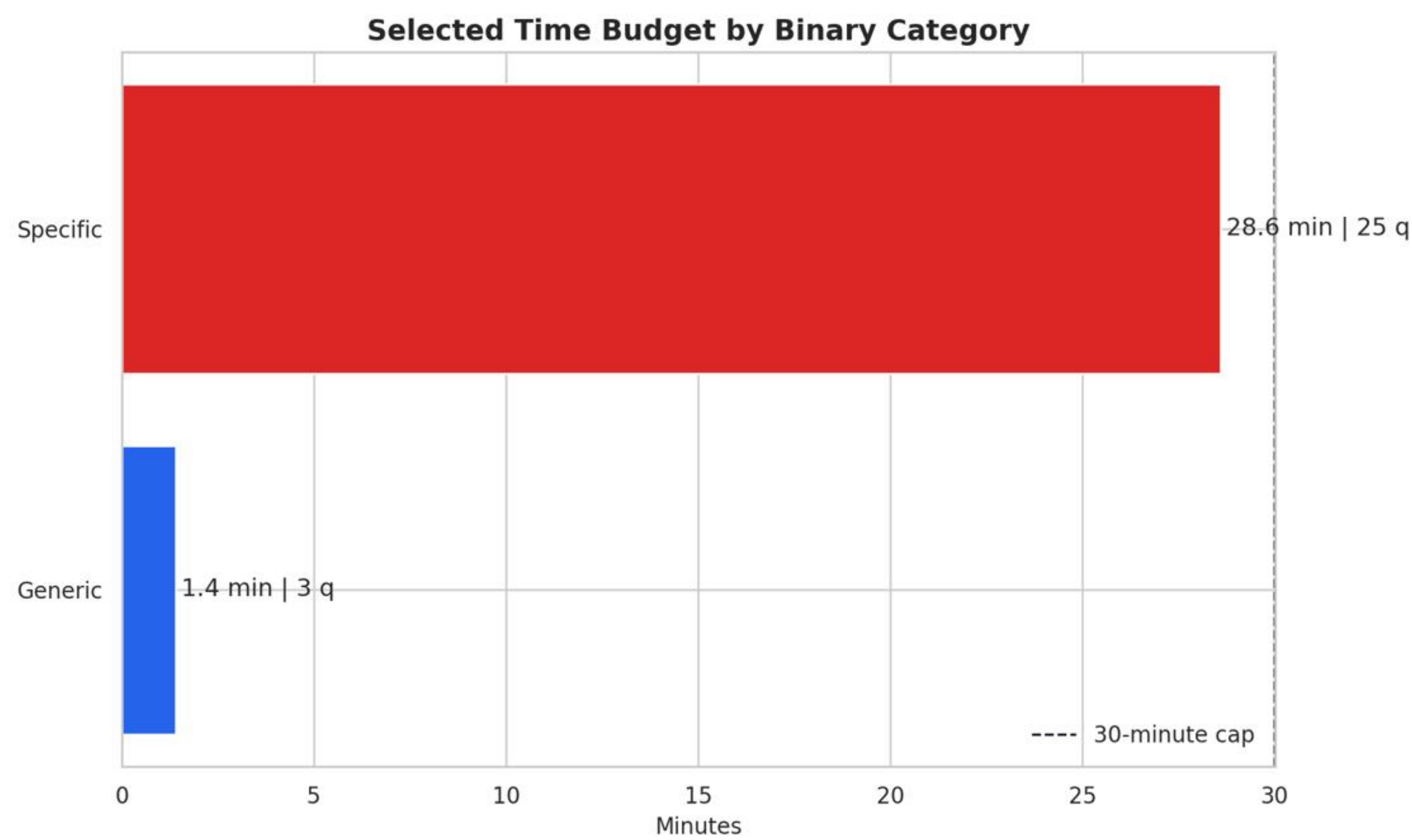
Analytical Figures

Selected figures from the refreshed artifact bundle

Top-ranked questions



Time budget by category



Discussion of Skew

Why financial questions appear fewer and why demographics fall away

Main interpretation

- The earlier output looked skewed partly because Financial Crisis appeared as its own visible module label.
- In the refreshed package, financial items compete inside Specific alongside disaster and pandemic items.
- Several financial items are close variants of one another, so redundancy penalties push some of them down.
- Katrina disaster items remain numerous and competitive, which reduces the share of finance-labeled items in the final shortlist.
- Demographic-only rows score lower on average because they add context rather than direct crisis signal.

Demographic versus non-demographic averages

Group	Rows	Average Ri	Average Pi
Demographics only	3	1.354	2.189
Non-demographic crisis items	49	2.253	2.584

Takeaway: the refreshed package still retains high-value financial material, but it no longer presents finance as if it were the only or dominant crisis dimension. The selected module is better read as a broader shock-and-response instrument covering economic disruption, aid exposure, housing instability, and trauma-related impact.

Deliverables Summary

What is included for client use

Package contents

Deliverable	Use
Master_Questionnaire.xlsx	Internal spreadsheet with all rows, categories, source, universe, and scores
Deployable_Questionnaire.pdf	Questionnaire for deployment using cleaned wording and no demographics
Codebook.pdf	Technical documentation of functions, formulas, schema, and thresholds
Final_Report.pdf	Stakeholder-facing explanation of results and interpretation

Recommended next steps

- Review whether one of the current Generic items should be manually demoted if the client wants a stricter event-agnostic core.
- Compare the deployable questionnaire row by row against Tom's preferred formatting template before sign-off.
- Use the dashboard and figures as supplemental analytical materials rather than required client-facing content unless requested.

References

Selected sources used to support interpretation and reporting

References

- Panel Study of Income Dynamics (PSID): Main Interview, 2021. ICPSR 39190.
- Fifty Years of the Panel Study of Income Dynamics: Past, Present, and Future.
- User Guide for the 2019 Interviewing Year.
- User Guide for the 2021 Interviewing Year.
- User Guide for the 2023 Interviewing Year.
- PSID COVID-19 Measures documentation.
- Economic Impact Payments and Household Spending During the Pandemic. NBER.
- The Economic Impacts of COVID-19: Evidence from a New Public Database Built Using Private Sector Data.
- Internal analytical source: PSID Data Modeling Report Prompt Generation.md.